

imperative that we put these bright minds to work. We must come up with innovations that can rightly balance the design and electronics part of building highly efficient electric vehicles that are suitable for the unprecedented nature of India's automobile industry.

The EV industry is bound to be a tech-driven industry. The fundamental groundwork of what makes it a league apart from its predecessors is the very role of technology in bringing about new innovations to the sector. Design and electronics must go hand in hand. This is not a phase where we can distinguish between the two anymore. The vehicles can be transformed from what they are traditionally known to do and serve different yet specific needs of each customer in this diverse country.

The pain points of the average Indian vehicle-owner are many, which have been effectively recognised by some who have begun resolving them, whether it is through IoT-enabled vehicles or some other technology, giving meaning to the phrase 'Necessity is the mother of invention.' It is only a matter of time, until another necessity of the Indian customer gives birth to an invention that can resolve the pain of customers around the globe. As such, the role of tech startups becomes much more significant in heralding the new wave.

India for the world

The introduction of electric vehicles is seen as quite a coming-of-age moment for the automobile sector. This is possibly one of the first times when mobility seems both non-threatening to the environment and with multiple new possibilities of innovation. And as we know, Indians have a knack for innovation.

The EV industry is a huge opportunity for success, and while multinational companies look at India as a huge market for consumption, it has the potential to turn into a

provider for the rest of the world.

Deviating from the path that we took during the onset of the first automobile revolution of the country, this is possibly the time when we focus on creating vehicles that cater to the Indian market first and then take them on to the global front instead of the other way round. As the saying goes, 'Charity begins at home.' Similarly, the success of EV players eyeing to take on as a global player relies on how well they can serve the domestic market.

We are seeing the emergence of different brands that cater to

Phase 1 (FAME-I) failed to achieve its targets despite the government spending over eight billion (800 crore) rupees on it. The subsequent Phase 2 of the scheme has also so far not come close to achieving the targets set, despite a deadline extension.

The production linked incentive (PLI) for the manufacturing of the lithium-ion batteries also acknowledges only one part of the problem. And while many like to put the issue of rising fuel prices to be a contributing factor to push consumers to switch, it seldom is so easy to completely transform the public consuming habits.

INDIA MUST COME UP WITH INNOVATIONS THAT CAN RIGHTLY BALANCE THE DESIGN AND ELECTRONICS PART OF BUILDING HIGHLY EFFICIENT ELECTRIC VEHICLES THAT ARE SUITABLE FOR THE UNPRECEDENTED NATURE OF INDIA'S AUTOMOBILE INDUSTRY.

particularly Tier 2 and Tier 3 cities, while some target urban markets in Tier 1 cities. While some focus on low-speed vehicles, some provide high-speed options. These offerings are not just useful for boosting the Indian EV market but also similar markets in Africa, South America, and South Asia.

Moreover, it is recommended for Indian companies to turn their gaze from glamorous markets in the West and instead focus on smaller markets where they have a much bigger competitive advantage to make a bigger impact.

Manufacturing vs adoption: The tougher nut to crack

Manufacturing is an issue that has been promptly handled by the government by providing subsidies and incentives. But adoption tricks have not yielded the desired results. The Faster Adoption and Manufacturing of Electric Vehicles in India Scheme

We all know that the EV phase in the country has only just begun. The seed of innovation is sprouting in the industry where many OEMs want to grab a share of the pie, but in their own unique ways. This is the beauty of any nascent market—the sheer number of possibilities. Business models can take any shape and form, be it manufacturing, support, supply chain, or recycling.

India's EV industry has all the required ingredients to mimic the proven success it attained in the automotive industry decades ago. But one thing is certain, the space must harbour an ecosystem of collaboration and cooperation, which needs to start at the grassroots level. **EFY**

This article is based on the session 'Transition To Total Electric: Opportunities & Challenges' by Ashish Kumar, Founder and CEO of Amosta Solutions, which was presented at the November edition of Tech World Congress 2021, and has been prepared by Siddha Dhar, Business Journalist at EFY.